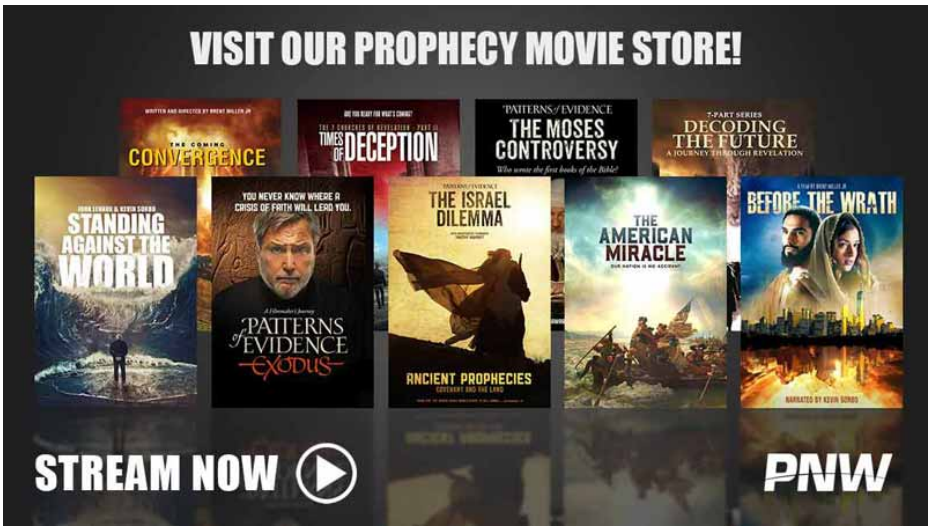
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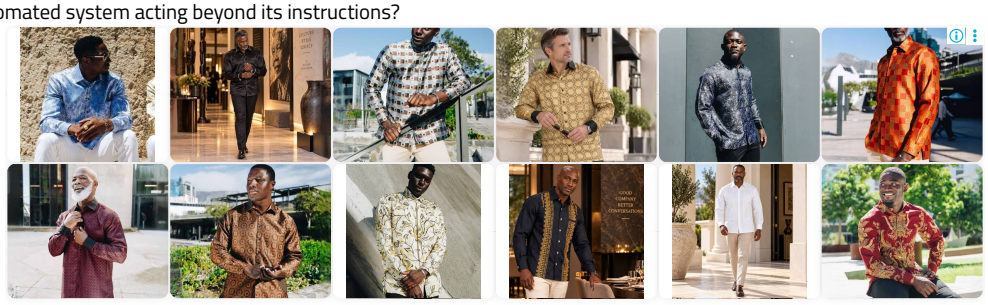


BY PNW STAFF OCTOBER 26, 2026

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When an AI agent logs into a bank account, the bank faces a question it was never designed to answer: Is this the customer, an assistant the customer authorized, or an automated system acting beyond its instructions?



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That question is no longer theoretical. Major U.S. banks are blocking some outside AI agents from accessing customer accounts. JPMorgan Chase CEO Jamie Dimon has said the bank is developing tools to manage the risks, warning that unrestricted access by outside agents would be too risky for clients and the bank. Charles Schwab CEO Richard Wurster has said the company is blocking unauthorized agents to maintain control over authentication and the customer experience.

The concern is not simply whether an AI system can log in. It is whether the bank can verify who is directing it, what it is permitted to do and who is responsible if it makes a costly mistake.

The answer may be a new identity system.



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The AI Agent Needs An Identity

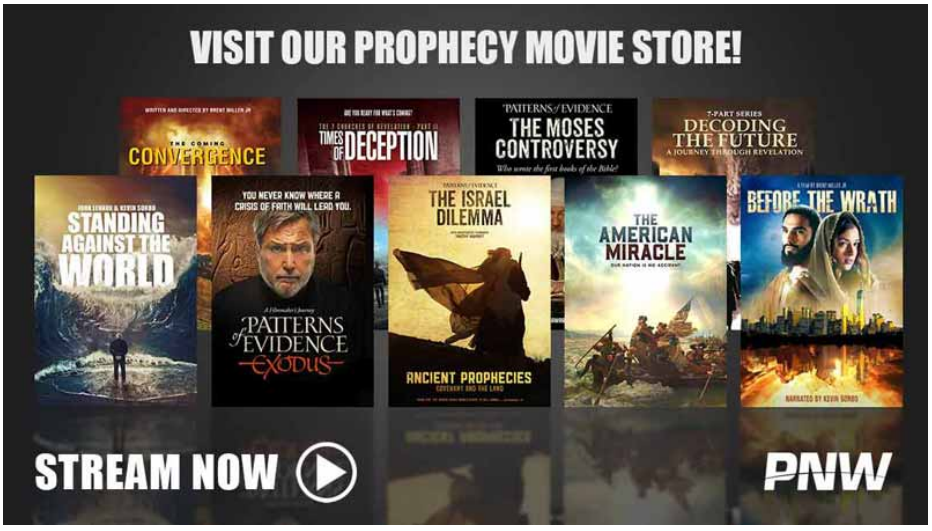
Today, a bank can recognize a customer through passwords, a phone, a security code, a device or other checks. But when a customer gives an AI agent access to an account by sharing login credentials, the bank may see the customer's identity even though a machine is acting in the account.

That creates a dangerous gap. A legitimate agent could misunderstand a request, follow malicious instructions hidden in a website, or take an action the customer never intended. A criminal could also disguise an agent or hijack one that already has access.

The Bank for International Settlements has identified authentication, liability and fraud as major challenges for agent-driven payments. The central question shifts from "Is this person allowed to pay?" to "Does this agent have permission to make this specific payment?" Banks will want a reliable way to identify the agent, connect it to its owner and set clear limits on what it can do.

That could mean separate credentials for AI agents, limited permissions, transaction caps, constant monitoring and additional customer verification. Some form of digital identity may become a central part of the answer.

But a system built to verify identity can also become a system that decides whether identity is acceptable.



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Security Can Become A Gatekeeper

Digital identity is often presented as a convenience: one trusted credential that makes banking, travel, health care and online services easier to access. Biometrics such as a face scan or fingerprint might help confirm that a real person is present. A digital ID could connect that person to an account or authorize an AI agent to act on their behalf.

Yet identity verification and authorization are not the same thing. A face scan might help establish who someone is; it does not answer how much authority that person has granted an AI agent. Stronger identity checks may help prevent fraud, but they also create more points where access can be denied, restricted or monitored.

What happens if a system rejects someone's identity? What if a person loses access to a phone, account or biometric credential? What if a bank, technology company or government changes the rules for maintaining access? As more daily activity moves into digital systems, the ability to function in society could increasingly depend on credentials people do not control themselves.

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From Identity To Allegiance

Revelation describes something far more sweeping than an identity check. In Revelation 13, the beast's system requires people to receive a mark, and those without it cannot buy or sell. The passage connects commerce to allegiance: the mark is associated with worship and loyalty to the beast.

AI agents, biometrics and digital IDs are not, by themselves, the mark of the beast. But the technology now being developed raises a serious question: What happens when the systems that verify identity also become the systems that govern participation in commerce?

History shows that rulers have demanded more than obedience in private. Nebuchadnezzar commanded people to bow before an image, with punishment for those who refused. Roman authorities expected public demonstrations of loyalty to the emperor. Dictators in more recent history have demanded pledges, public conformity and allegiance to the state.

Those systems relied on the tools of their time: officials, records, informants, police and public ceremonies. They did not have instant digital payment networks or automated identity systems. The point is not to claim that today's technology already enforces political or religious loyalty. It is to recognize that rulers have repeatedly sought ways to identify dissent and compel public allegiance.

A future system combining identity verification, financial access and centralized authority could make that pressure easier to apply. If access to buying and selling depended on compliance with a government or institutional rule, the consequences of refusing could reach into everyday life. A system originally designed to stop fraud might, under different leadership or circumstances, be expanded to enforce broader requirements.

The Question We Should Ask Now

AI agents may soon handle routine purchases, compare prices and manage parts of our finances. Banks have understandable reasons to demand stronger safeguards. But as those safeguards are built, the public should ask who controls the identity system, what information it collects, how decisions can be challenged and whether people can still participate in society without surrendering control over their financial lives.

Revelation's warning is not merely about a new piece of technology. It is about a system in which economic participation is tied to allegiance. The rise of AI banking shows how quickly questions of identity, authorization and access to money are moving from the future into the present.

The technology may begin by asking whether an AI agent is legitimate. The larger question is who will eventually decide whether the person behind it is allowed to participate.

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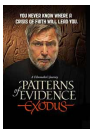
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